

Employee Code of Conduct

Meridian Global Corp — Confidential Internal Document

****Employee Code of Conduct****

1. Introduction and Purpose

Meridian Global Corp is dedicated to fostering a work environment built on integrity, respect, and professionalism. This Employee Code of Conduct ("the Code") outlines the ethical standards, legal obligations, and core values that guide our global operations and employee behavior. Adherence to this Code is a condition of employment and fundamental to maintaining the trust of our colleagues, customers, partners, and the communities we serve. It provides a framework for making sound ethical decisions in all business dealings and reflects our commitment to excellence as a 40,000-employee multinational technology company.

2. Workplace Ethics and Mutual Respect

All Meridian employees are expected to treat colleagues, customers, and partners with dignity, professionalism, and mutual respect, fostering an inclusive environment free from prejudice or discrimination. We champion open communication, constructive feedback, and collaborative teamwork across all our global offices. Employees must demonstrate honesty, integrity, and accountability in all interactions and business practices, respecting diverse perspectives and contributing positively to our work culture.

3. Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination Policy

Meridian Global Corp maintains a zero-tolerance policy against any form of harassment or discrimination. This includes, but is not limited to, harassment based on race, color, religion, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law. Harassment encompasses verbal, physical, visual, and electronic forms. Any employee witnessing or experiencing harassment or discrimination is obligated to report it to Human Resources within forty-eight (48) hours of the incident or knowledge thereof. All reports will be handled confidentially, investigated promptly, and impartially. Retaliation against any employee for making a good-faith report or cooperating in an investigation is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action.

4. Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where their personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with Meridian Global Corp's best interests. This includes holding financial interests

in competing companies, accepting substantial gifts or favors from vendors, or using company resources for personal gain. To ensure transparency, all employees are required to complete and submit an annual Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form by September 30th each year. New employees must submit this form within 30 days of their start date. Failure to disclose potential conflicts may lead to disciplinary action.

5. Confidentiality and Protection of Proprietary Information

Meridian's intellectual property and proprietary information are critical assets. This includes trade secrets, product roadmaps, financial data, marketing strategies, customer lists, and personal data of employees or customers. Employees must handle all sensitive company data with utmost care, accessing or disclosing it only on a strict need-to-know basis for legitimate business purposes. The obligation to protect Meridian's confidential information extends for a period of two (2) years following separation from employment. Unauthorized disclosure or misuse will result in severe disciplinary action, including termination and potential legal proceedings.

6. Social Media Guidelines

Employees are expected to exercise professional judgment when engaging on social media platforms, whether for personal or professional use. While personal expression is respected, online conduct reflects upon Meridian Global Corp. Employees must not disclose any confidential, proprietary, or non-public company information. Specifically, the disclosure of unreleased products, future technologies, or internal projects is strictly prohibited. Employees should clarify that personal views do not represent Meridian. Any online activity harmful to Meridian's reputation or business interests, or which creates a hostile work environment, is prohibited.

7. Whistleblower Protection and Anonymous Reporting

Meridian Global Corp encourages employees to report any suspected violations of this Code, company policies, or applicable laws without fear of retaliation. Robust whistleblower protection is provided to safeguard those who make good-faith reports. Retaliation against a whistleblower will result in severe disciplinary action. For anonymous reporting, Meridian operates a dedicated Ethics Hotline, accessible 24/7, at 1-800-555-0199. All reports received through this hotline will be investigated thoroughly and confidentially.

8. Enforcement and Disciplinary Action

Violations of this Employee Code of Conduct will be addressed promptly and consistently. Disciplinary actions are generally progressive, though Meridian reserves the right to deviate based on the severity of the infraction. Typical steps include:

1. ****Verbal Warning:**** Documented counsel for minor infractions, with clear expectation for improvement.
2. ****Written Warning:**** For repeat minor infractions or serious first-time offenses, clearly outlining the violation and required corrective action.
3. ****Final Written Warning/Suspension:**** For continued non-compliance or significant breaches, potentially involving a period of unpaid suspension.
4. ****Termination of Employment:**** For severe violations, persistent non-compliance, or a cumulative pattern of misconduct.

Meridian Global Corp ensures fairness and due process in all disciplinary proceedings.

This Code is effective as of January 1, 2024.

Issued by the Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer, Meridian Global Corp.